

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Ella Gance

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Ella Gance

Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture

Ella dresses as though the society pages arrive before the guests. Ella has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year.

- Collects work by **Vincent Van Faux** and **Elle Loominate**.
- Competes socially and at auction with **Elon Mosaic**.

ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Ella Gance. I collect beautiful things and attend beautiful evenings. I am prepared to be disappointed by neither.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Ella Gance

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant knew you quietly sold a work you had publicly promised to donate to another institution and planned to expose the contradiction.

Your other secret

You sold it to cover a failed business investment and hoped to replace it before anyone noticed.

Conversations to start

- Ask Vincent Van Faux what the museum expects a collector to donate.
- Compare gala expectations with Elon Mosaic. Keep your withdrawn donation private for now.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The keyboard has a secret below middle C, but not among the keys.*
- 2 *Follow the streets of Barcelona with your eyes, then inspect what lies over them.*
- 3 *Find the household's frozen collection. One exhibit is made of paper.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I sold the work I had promised to donate. A failed investment made the promise unaffordable. I hoped to bring a replacement before anyone asked. Grant knew where the original had gone and intended to reveal it in his announcement. I had invited people to see me thanked for something I could not deliver.

IF MURDERER

I sold the work I had promised to donate. A failed investment made the promise unaffordable. I hoped to bring a replacement before anyone asked. Grant knew where the original had gone and intended to reveal it in his announcement. I wanted him stopped before the room heard that story.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I stopped the assistant from unpacking the replacement work I had brought. It was not the piece I promised, and I wanted time to explain before it reached the donor display. Grant asked where the original was. I said it was unavailable; I had sold it. The assistant kept the packing list. I had come dressed to be thanked for a donation I could no longer make. I was trying to keep that fact out of the photographs.

IF MURDERER

I stopped the assistant from unpacking the replacement work I had brought. It was not the piece I promised, and I wanted time to explain before it reached the donor display. Grant asked where the original was. I said it was unavailable; I had sold it. The assistant kept the packing list. I had come dressed to be thanked for a donation I could no longer make. I was trying to keep that fact out of the photographs.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:32.
The entrance record is my first admission at 6:32. The assistant retained the replacement work's packing list and photographed it before unpacking. It is not the work I promised. The sale invoice predates tonight, and the failed investment is mine. The packing records corroborate the substitution I was trying to conceal.

IF MURDERER

The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:16. The entrance record confirms the first admission I described. I folded the silk wrapping while he read. The replacement would conceal my failed promise. It was a financial compromise I should have explained to the institution expecting the original. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my evening bag. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while presenting the replacement offer.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Ella Gance

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Ella Gance

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I sold the promised donation and brought a replacement I hoped nobody would unpack too quickly. My first arrival was 6:32, after the bottle was locked away. I did not kill Grant. I will notify the institution expecting the original and offer repayment. The packing list can say what I brought without calling it what I promised.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my evening bag when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He had the correspondence about the promise I could not fulfill. I killed him before the announcement instead of answering for it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.